

AFRIVATE LEAVE AND ABSENCE POLICY

Document Code	AFRI-LAP-01
Status	Official — Binding
Applies To	All Team Members within Agreed Capacity (paid or unpaid)
Policy Owner	People & Culture
Effective Date	2 August 2026
Related	AFRI-SWP · AFRI-DOA-01 · AFRI-ICEF-01 · AFRI-TLOP-01

What “leave” means: For unpaid Internal Contributors, leave is **authorised absence from Agreed Capacity** under AFRI-ICEF-01. It is not, by itself, statutory annual leave, paid leave, or an employment benefit. For any future paid Employee, statutory rights under Nigerian law apply in addition to this process; this Policy still governs how absence is requested and approved in Afrivate systems.

1. PURPOSE

This Policy sets the exclusive process for requesting and deciding absence from duty at Afrivate Technologies Ltd, so wellbeing and continuity are balanced without informal or ambiguous approvals.

2. DEFINITIONS

- **Leave:** Authorised absence from Agreed Capacity / scheduled duty for stated dates.
- **Official work days:** Monday–Thursday, excluding public holidays and company-declared non-working days.
- **Unauthorised absence:** Any absence from Agreed Capacity without a Portal decision of “approved” (except while an emergency is being regularised under §6 in good faith).

3. NOTICE REQUIREMENT

Except under §6 (emergency), every leave request must be submitted in the Portal at least **three (3) official work days** before the first intended day of absence.

No constructive approval: Submission is not approval. The Team Member remains available for duty until People & Culture’s decision appears in the Portal as approved.

4. HANDOVER (CONDITION OF PROCEEDING)

Before starting approved leave, the Team Member must:

- Complete due work for the period; or
- Agree reassignment with the Team Lead to a named colleague;
- Provide handover (status, deadlines, files, access, next actions); and
- Obtain confirmation that the Team Lead and receiving colleague understand the temporary ownership.

People & Culture may delay or decline leave where handover is inadequate and continuity would be materially affected.

5. APPROVAL AUTHORITY (EXCLUSIVE RULE)

1. Every request must state truthful reason, dates, and supporting information where required.
2. The Team Lead must record an operational recommendation in the Portal within **one (1) official work day** (impact, handover, capacity).
3. **People & Culture alone approves or declines**, after considering reason, urgency, notice, handover, capacity, and attendance history. The CEO may override in writing.
4. A Team Lead Portal action is a recommendation only, unless the CEO has issued a written, time-bound delegation naming the delegate and scope (see AFRI-DOA-01). Silence is not delegation.
5. Where a request is declined, People & Culture will ordinarily state the reason in the Portal.

6. OFFICIAL CHANNEL

Leave requests must be submitted through the **AfriVate Portal**. Requests made solely through WhatsApp, Slack, email, telephone, or verbal conversation are not leave and will not be treated as approved.

1. Sign in to the Portal.
2. Open Leave / Time off; select leave type.
3. Enter dates and clear reason.
4. Add handover details and supporting documents where required.
5. Submit and await the Portal decision.

7. EMERGENCY AND IMPROMPTU ABSENCE

Notice under §3 may be impossible only for:

- **Medical emergency:** Urgent illness, injury, hospital admission, or immediate medical situation affecting the Team Member or a person under their direct care.

- **Specified personal emergency:** A serious, unforeseen personal event requiring immediate presence; circumstances must be stated in the Portal and may require reasonable supporting information.

The Team Member must notify the Team Lead and People & Culture as soon as reasonably possible and submit or regularise the Portal request at the earliest opportunity. Emergency notice is not automatic approval and must not be used to evade ordinary process.

8. CONSEQUENCES

Repeated late requests, unauthorised absence, or misuse of §7 may result in coaching, verbal or written warning, closer review of future requests, or further action under AFRI-SWP progressive discipline — assessed fairly on explanation, evidence, history, and impact.

9. RESPONSIBILITIES

- **Team Members:** Timely accurate requests; handover; wait for Portal approval.
- **Team Leads:** Assess impact; support handover; record recommendation within one official work day.
- **People & Culture:** Decide consistently; record in Portal; maintain records.

Hard rule: No leave is approved until the decision appears in the AfriVate Portal.

10. GOVERNING LAW

Governed by the laws of the Federal Republic of Nigeria. Severability and no-waiver apply. Amendments only by CEO-authorised publication under Portal Resources.